

2c. Content of Comparative and contextual study (Component 02)

There is a choice of five topics as follows:

- American Literature 1880–1940
- The Gothic
- Dystopia
- Women in Literature
- The Immigrant Experience.

Learners choose **one** topic and study at least **two** texts in their chosen topic area, at least **one** of which must be from the core set text list.

For the second text, centres may choose to study the other core set text (listed in the table below) **or** they may choose another text, from the same topic area, from the list of suggested set texts. Please see Appendix 5d for the complete list of core and suggested set texts for this component.

Centres should design a balanced course for learners, avoiding overlap between topics chosen for Comparative and contextual study and for the non examined assessment component.

Comparative and contextual study		
Topics: Close reading	Knowledge, skills and understanding	Learners should be able to:
Learners choose one topic: • American Literature 1880–1940 • The Gothic • Dystopia • Women in Literature • The Immigrant Experience.	Learners are required to read widely and independently in their chosen topic of study. Learners are required to demonstrate close reading skills in analysing unseen prose extracts. Learners are required to identify and consider how attitudes and values are expressed in unseen extracts. Learners are required to communicate fluently, accurately and effectively their knowledge, understanding and judgement of unseen extracts.	• analyse ways in which writers shape meanings • demonstrate understanding of the significance and influence of contexts in which literary texts are written and received • articulate informed, personal and creative responses using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

Topics and set texts: Comparative essay	Knowledge, skills and understanding	Learners should be able to:
Learners study two texts, at least one must be from the list below:	Learners are required to explore contrasts, connections and comparisons between	• demonstrate understanding of the significance and influence of contexts in which the chosen texts were written and received.